

U.S. Beverages, Household & Personal Care Products

U.S. HPC Scanner Update: beauty remains the bright spot as household demand stays soft



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U.S. HPC scanner trends remained mixed in the latest quarter. We publish our Q3 QTD scanner update, covering the period ending July 11, with comparisons against Q2 and Q1. Beauty continues to be the bright spot, while Household and Family Care categories remain relatively subdued.

Among our coverage names, **P&G** delivered +2.5% sales growth in Q3 QTD, down from +3.0% in Q2, reflecting moderating category growth and softer pricing. Beauty remained P&G's strongest segment (+6.4%), supported by +4.7% volume growth, while Fabric & Home Care grew +2.2% and Baby, Feminine & Family Care increased just +0.5%.

Colgate posted +3.5% sales growth in Q3 QTD, down from +4.0% in Q2, driven by improving volume trends, particularly in Home Care (+8.3%) and Pet Nutrition (+6.5%). Oral Care remained positive at +1.7%, while Personal Care declined 4.0%.

e.l.f. Beauty's total sales grew +1.0% in Q3 QTD, down from +1.2% in Q2, as weakness in Cosmetics (-6.3%) was offset by continued strength in Skin Care (+38.8%). For e.l.f., we used Nielsen's xAOC dataset rather than U.S. Full View to better reflect Naturium's underlying performance, as changes to Naturium's Amazon distribution strategy may distort trends in the U.S. Full View dataset. Even on this basis, Naturium remained the standout performer, generating +58.2% sales growth, driven by +88.1% volume growth. Notably, Nielsen captured e.l.f.'s Hair Care business for the first time this quarter. The category represented ~4% of company sales during the period and provides an incremental growth driver beyond Cosmetics and Skin Care, and it is not yet reflected in the Cosmetics/Skin Care segment tables below. We will incorporate Hair Care into future e.l.f. scanner updates.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	20 Jul 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
ELF (elf)	M	USD	79.65	60.00	(50.5)%	USD	3.13	3.20	3.52	25.4	24.9	22.7
PG (Procter & Gamble Co)	M	USD	149.13	156.00	(22.1)%	USD	6.83	6.86	7.12	21.8	21.7	20.9
CL (Colgate-Palmolive Co)	M	USD	91.93	96.00	(12.3)%	USD	3.68	3.87	4.09	25.0	23.8	22.5
SPX			7,443.28									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

ELF base year is 2026;

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate **e.l.f Beauty Market-Perform**, with a PT of \$60. We believe e.l.f has the most relevant operating model for today's consumer -social media fluency, rapid innovation cycles, and a viral-prone approach to new product development. However, EPS have been extremely volatile after a big acquisition (Rhode), distribution expansion, increased marketing and payroll investments and a slowing-down core. We are long term believers, but think some stability and margin expansion is needed before the stock can appreciate.

We forecast 2% and 7% YoY EPS growth NTM and NTM+1, respectively, making us bearish vs. consensus on NTM+1 EPS by ~5%. We have a target multiple of 17x.

We rate **Procter & Gamble Market-Perform**, with a PT of \$156. P&G has a diversified portfolio (categories and regions) that is, by design, hard to accelerate or disrupt. Bright spots in Beauty (relative to the rest of the portfolio) will help sustain LSD organic sales growth, with potential upside from upcoming innovation in Laundry Detergents, but challenges from Private Label in more commoditized categories like Bathroom Tissue and from smaller competitors in Disposable Diapers are unlikely to go away.

We forecast 1% and 5% YoY EPS growth NTM and NTM+1, respectively, making us bearish vs. consensus on NTM+1 EPS by ~1%. We have a target multiple of 21.6x.

We rate **Colgate-Palmolive Market-Perform**, with a PT of \$96. Colgate has the most productive geographic footprint in our coverage, balancing diversification with growth and powered by strong HPC Brands in International markets. While HPC will be partially weighed down by their underperforming North America segment (stagnant categories, share loss), we like CL's Global Pet business, which will further premiumize as Cat Food, which has a higher price per pound, grows faster than Dog Food.

We forecast 4% and 9% YoY EPS growth NTM and NTM+1, respectively, making us bullish vs. consensus on NTM+1 EPS by ~2%. We have a target multiple of 23.1x.

DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: 2026 Q3 QTD Performance - PG

Latest Period End: 2026-07-11

	Volume (EQ,		YoY Sales	YoY Volume	YoY Price	Sales Mix	Market	YoY Mkt	Category	
	Sales (\$M)	M)	Price (\$/EQ)	Growth	Growth	Growth	(%)	Share (%)		Share Chg (pp)
Fabric & Home Care	1,386	7,416	0.19	2.2%	-1.0%	3.2%	35.3%	27.8%	0.7%	-0.5%
Baby, Feminine & Family Care	1,151	5,116	0.23	0.5%	1.1%	-0.6%	29.3%	29.1%	-0.2%	1.1%
Grooming	192	79	2.42	3.9%	1.2%	2.8%	4.9%	38.1%	0.5%	2.5%
Health Care	525	1,175	0.45	2.0%	4.1%	-2.0%	13.4%	9.8%	0.0%	2.0%
Beauty	633	942	0.67	6.4%	4.7%	1.7%	16.1%	8.9%	0.3%	3.4%
Other	39	12	3.24	10.9%	-3.6%	15.0%	1.0%	0.1%	0.0%	2.5%
Total	3,926	14,739	0.27	2.5%	0.5%	2.0%	100.0%	5.0%	0.0%	2.3%

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 2: 2026 Q2 Performance - PG

Latest Period End: 2026-06-27

				YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt	Category
	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)						Share Chg (pp)	Growth YoY
Fabric & Home Care	4,859	26,877	0.18	1.5%	-0.4%	1.9%	35.4%	29.1%	-0.4%	2.7%
Baby, Feminine & Family Care	3,992	18,606	0.21	1.6%	-0.4%	2.0%	29.1%	28.9%	-0.1%	2.1%
Grooming	631	271	2.33	5.0%	1.8%	3.1%	4.6%	38.7%	0.2%	4.5%
Health Care	1,961	4,349	0.45	5.2%	-0.6%	5.9%	14.3%	10.2%	0.2%	3.2%
Beauty	2,188	3,283	0.67	5.8%	1.0%	4.7%	15.9%	9.3%	0.0%	6.1%
Other	97	31	3.11	16.8%	6.5%	9.7%	0.7%	0.0%	0.0%	2.7%
Total	13,728	53,418	0.26	3.0%	-0.3%	3.3%	100.0%	5.1%	0.0%	3.0%

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

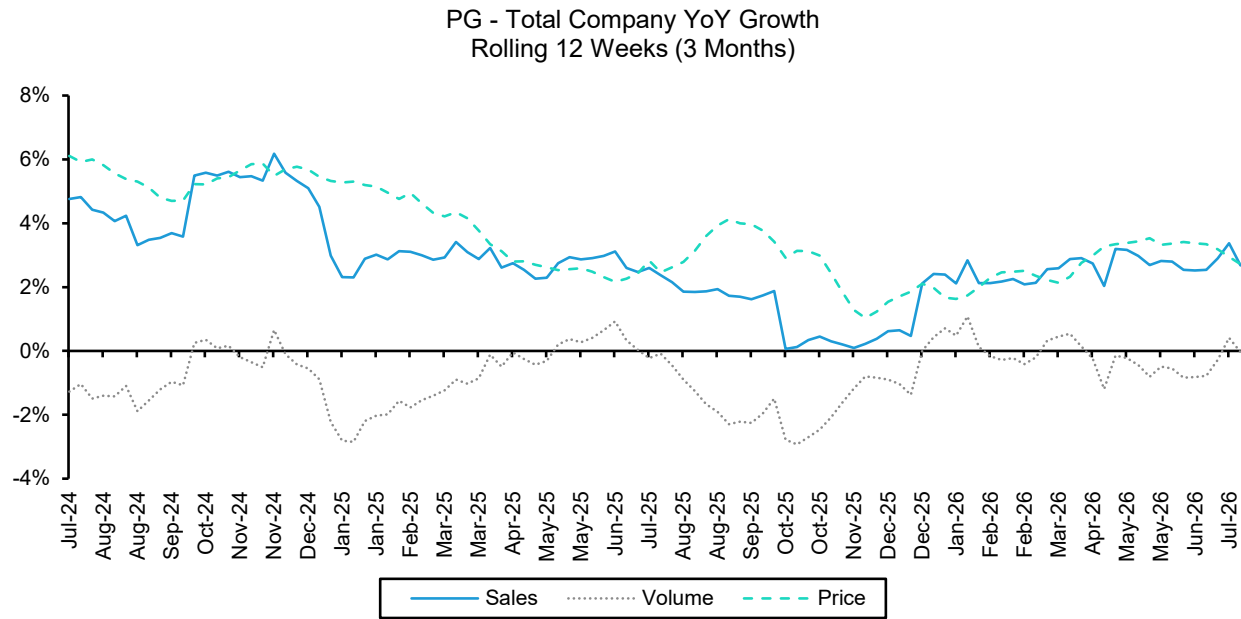
EXHIBIT 3: 2026 Q1 Performance - PG

Latest Period End: 2026-03-21

				YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt	Category Growth YoY
	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)						Share Chg (pp)	
Fabric & Home Care	4,290	24,415	0.18	2.4%	1.6%	0.8%	35.8%	30.6%	-0.2%	3.2%
Baby, Feminine & Family Care	3,501	17,991	0.19	1.4%	-0.4%	1.8%	29.2%	29.0%	-0.4%	2.9%
Grooming	479	208	2.30	-1.1%	-6.1%	5.3%	4.0%	37.8%	-1.4%	2.7%
Health Care	1,944	4,139	0.47	2.5%	-2.5%	5.1%	16.2%	11.1%	0.1%	1.7%
Beauty	1,745	2,662	0.66	6.5%	0.7%	5.7%	14.6%	9.4%	-0.1%	7.4%
Other	18	8	2.37	36.3%	15.3%	18.2%	0.2%	0.0%	0.0%	4.4%
Total	11,978	49,422	0.24	2.6%	0.4%	2.1%	100.0%	5.2%	-0.1%	4.3%

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **PG Overall Performance Trends**



Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 5: PG Performance Trends by Segment

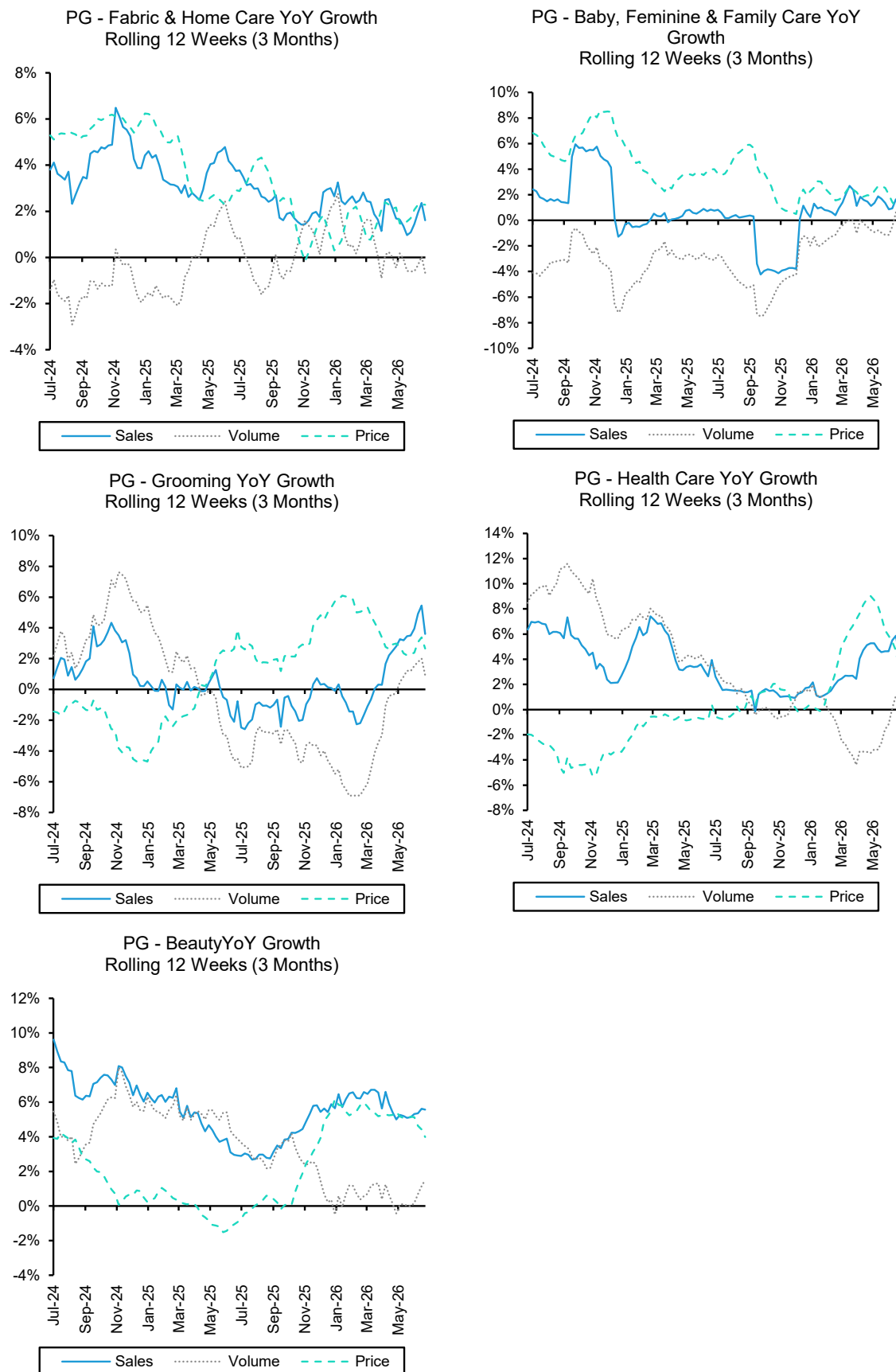


EXHIBIT 6: **2026 Q3 QTD Performance - CL**

Latest Period End: 2026-07-11

	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)	YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt Share Chg (pp)	Category Growth YoY
Oral Care	187	247	0.76	1.7%	-2.4%	4.2%	19.2%	17.8%	0.1%	0.8%
Personal Care	90	352	0.26	-4.0%	-8.9%	5.3%	9.2%	2.2%	-0.2%	4.5%
Home Care	104	1,332	0.08	8.3%	10.1%	-1.7%	10.6%	3.8%	0.2%	1.9%
Oral, Personal, and Household Care	381	1,930	0.20	1.9%	4.4%	-2.4%	39.0%	4.9%	-0.1%	3.1%
Pet	214	54	3.97	6.5%	-0.5%	7.0%	21.9%	5.1%	0.1%	3.3%
Total	595	1,984	0.30	3.5%	4.3%	-0.7%	61.0%	0.8%	0.0%	2.3%

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 7: **2026 Q2 Performance - CL**

Latest Period End: 2026-06-27

	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)	YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt Share Chg (pp)	Category Growth YoY
Oral Care	608	790	0.77	2.1%	-1.4%	3.6%	18.8%	16.8%	-0.4%	4.8%
Personal Care	295	1,174	0.25	2.2%	-4.6%	7.1%	9.1%	2.2%	-0.1%	8.2%
Home Care	338	4,143	0.08	2.8%	-0.6%	3.4%	10.5%	3.6%	0.0%	2.6%
Oral, Personal, and Household Care	1,242	6,108	0.20	2.3%	-1.5%	3.9%	38.5%	4.7%	-0.2%	5.7%
Pet	745	189	3.94	7.0%	0.3%	6.7%	23.1%	5.1%	0.2%	3.6%
Total	1,987	6,297	0.32	4.0%	-1.4%	5.5%	61.5%	0.7%	0.0%	3.0%

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

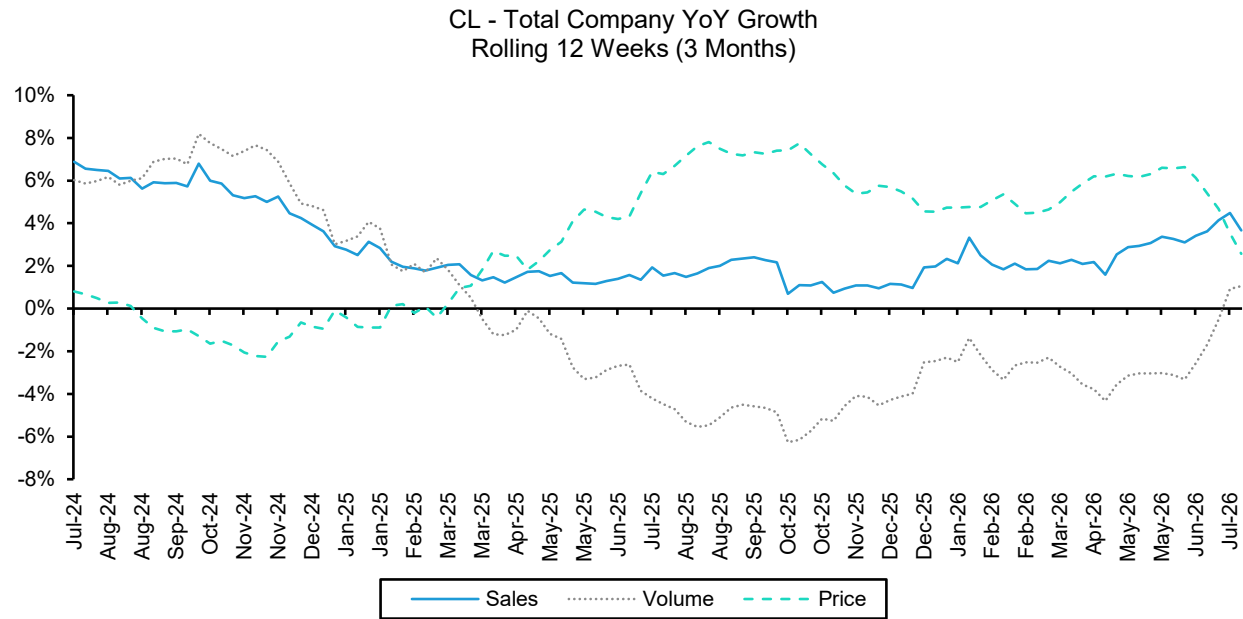
EXHIBIT 8: **2026 Q1 Performance - CL**

Latest Period End: 2026-03-21

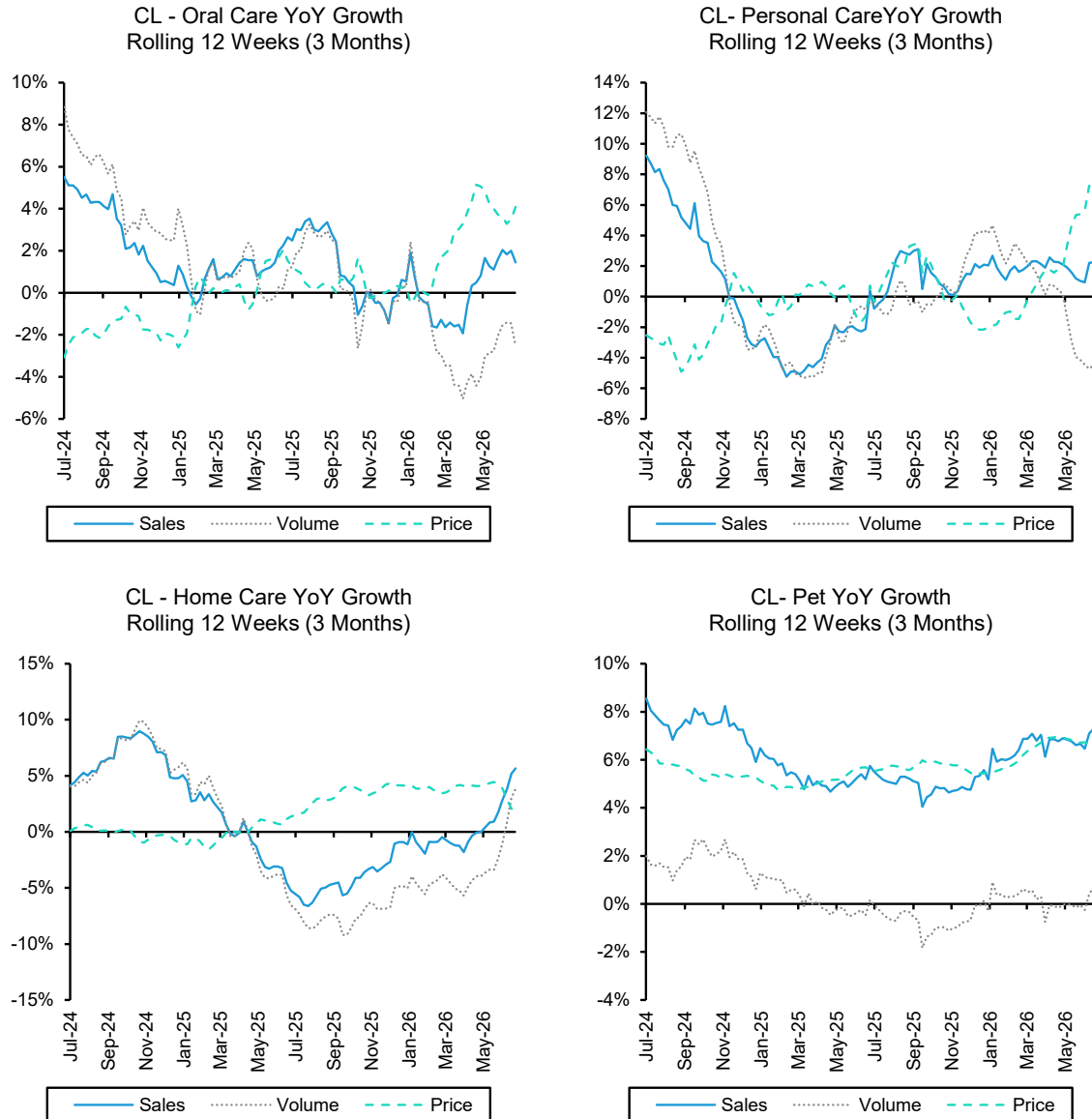
	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)	YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt Share Chg (pp)	Category Growth YoY
Oral Care	516	697	0.74	-1.6%	-3.5%	1.9%	18.9%	16.5%	-1.0%	4.1%
Personal Care	232	1,130	0.21	2.0%	2.2%	-0.2%	8.5%	2.2%	-0.2%	9.2%
Home Care	293	3,623	0.08	-0.8%	-4.2%	3.5%	10.7%	3.6%	-0.1%	3.0%
Oral, Personal, and Household Care	1,041	5,450	0.19	-0.6%	-2.8%	2.3%	38.2%	4.7%	-0.3%	6.1%
Pet	642	167	3.84	6.9%	0.5%	6.4%	23.6%	5.0%	0.1%	4.0%
Total	1,683	5,617	0.30	2.1%	-2.7%	5.0%	61.8%	0.7%	0.0%	4.3%

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 9: CL Overall Performance Trends



Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 10: **CL Performance Trends by Segment**

Source: Nielsen Total US Full View (Modeled) + Conv + Pet Retail + Costco (Model) + Rem Accounts, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 11: **2026 Q3 QTD Performance - ELF**

Latest Period End: 2026-07-11

	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)	YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt Share Chg (pp)	Category Growth YoY
Face Cosmetics	35	3	11.61	-3.8%	-8.1%	4.7%	40.1%	23.4%	-0.7%	-0.9%
Eye Cosmetics	14	0	51.51	5.9%	-11.3%	19.4%	15.6%	9.4%	0.5%	0.7%
Lip Cosmetics	9	0	35.26	-34.4%	-49.8%	30.7%	10.4%	12.4%	-5.9%	-3.2%
All Other Cosmetics	10	2	4.45	8.7%	13.7%	-4.4%	11.8%	1.4%	0.2%	-5.1%
Total Cosmetics	68	6	11.62	-6.3%	-4.5%	-1.9%	77.9%	6.2%	-0.2%	-3.7%
ELF Skin Care	9	2	4.63	21.3%	1.7%	19.3%	10.1%	0.6%	0.1%	0.8%
Naturium Skin Care	10	6	1.74	58.2%	88.1%	-15.9%	12.0%	0.8%	0.3%	0.8%
Total Skin Care	19	8	2.43	38.8%	56.1%	-11.1%	22.1%	1.4%	0.4%	0.8%
Total	88	14	6.34	1.0%	22.9%	-17.9%	100.0%	3.6%	0.1%	-1.3%

Source: Nielsen Total US xAOC, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 12: **2026 Q2 Performance - ELF**

Latest Period End: 2026-06-27

	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)	YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt Share Chg (pp)	Category Growth YoY
Face Cosmetics	131	11	12.25	-4.2%	-13.7%	11.1%	40.1%	22.7%	-0.8%	-0.8%
Eye Cosmetics	52	1	55.59	11.6%	-11.6%	26.2%	16.0%	9.5%	0.8%	2.5%
Lip Cosmetics	37	1	34.69	-31.6%	-45.6%	25.7%	11.3%	12.7%	-5.7%	-0.9%
All Other Cosmetics	37	7	5.52	0.7%	-13.7%	16.7%	11.3%	1.4%	0.0%	-1.1%
Total Cosmetics	257	19	13.26	-6.2%	-16.3%	12.1%	78.6%	6.3%	-0.4%	-0.6%
ELF Skin Care	35	6	5.39	38.4%	-3.2%	43.0%	10.6%	0.8%	0.2%	4.1%
Naturium Skin Care	35	19	1.83	48.0%	72.9%	-14.4%	10.8%	0.8%	0.2%	4.1%
Total Skin Care	70	26	2.72	43.1%	44.4%	-0.9%	21.4%	1.5%	0.4%	4.1%
Total	327	45	7.26	1.2%	10.0%	-8.0%	100.0%	3.8%	0.0%	1.8%

Source: Nielsen Total US xAOC, Bernstein Analysis

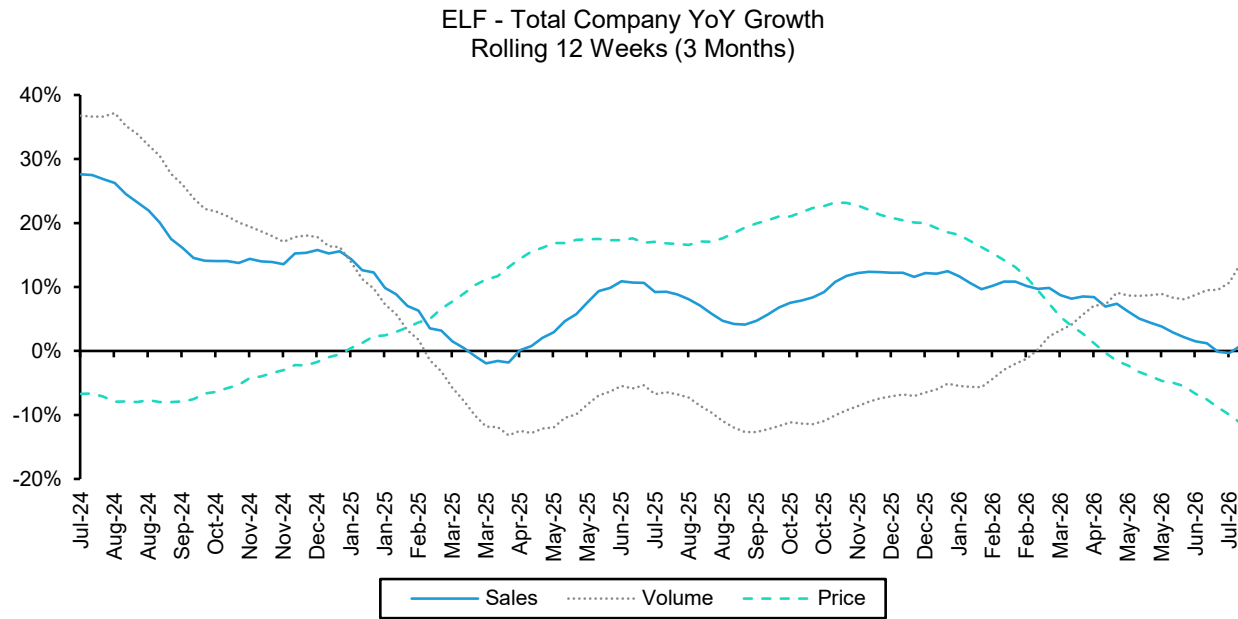
EXHIBIT 13: **2026 Q1 Performance - ELF**

Latest Period End: 2026-03-21

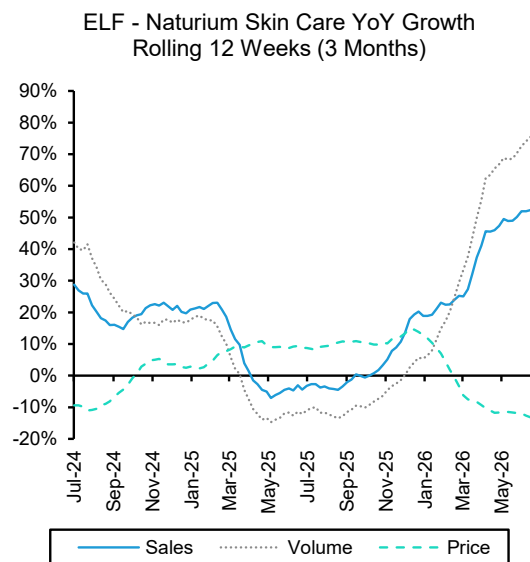
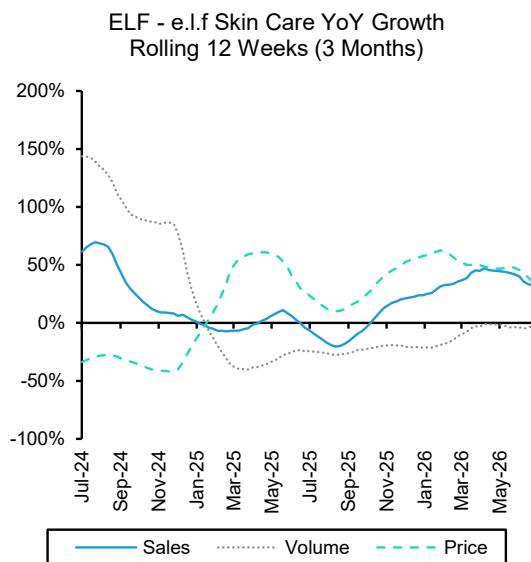
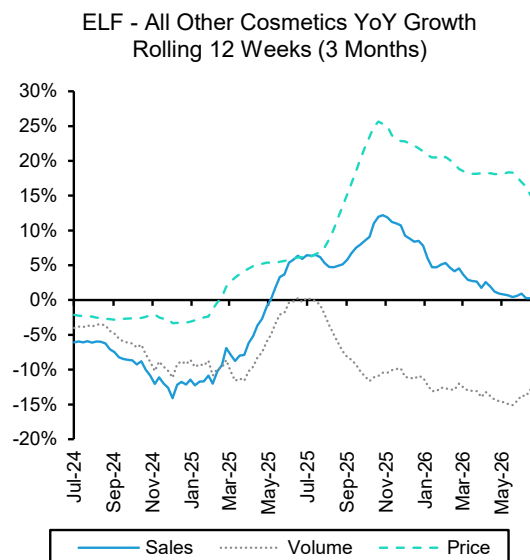
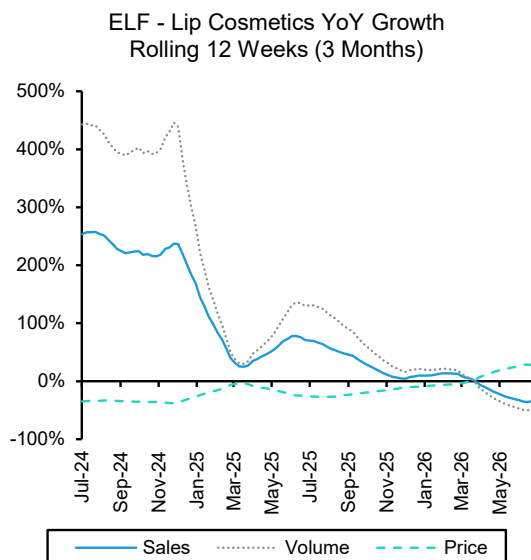
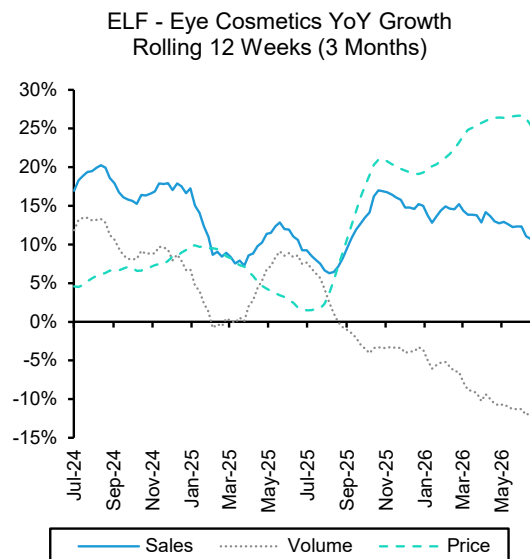
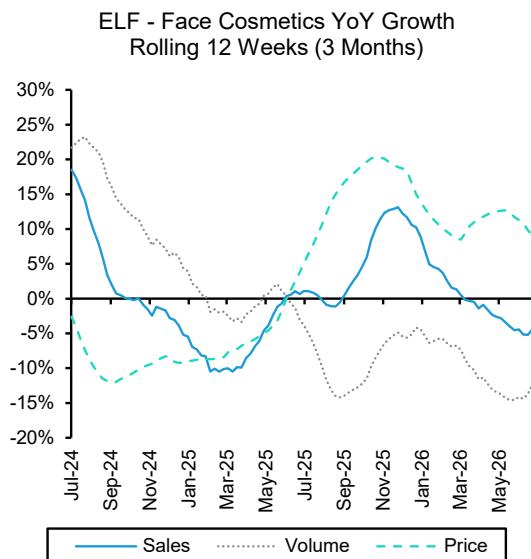
	Sales (\$M)	Volume (EQ, M)	Price (\$/EQ)	YoY Sales Growth	YoY Volume Growth	YoY Price Growth	Sales Mix (%)	Market Share (%)	YoY Mkt Share Chg (pp)	Category Growth YoY
Face Cosmetics	109	9	12.32	0.8%	-7.3%	8.7%	40.0%	22.9%	-0.1%	1.1%
Eye Cosmetics	44	1	54.61	14.4%	-7.8%	24.1%	16.2%	9.7%	1.0%	2.6%
Lip Cosmetics	39	1	34.12	8.5%	12.0%	-3.2%	14.1%	15.8%	0.6%	4.6%
All Other Cosmetics	31	6	5.45	3.8%	-12.3%	18.3%	11.3%	1.3%	0.0%	1.6%
Total Cosmetics	223	16	13.53	4.9%	-8.0%	14.1%	81.6%	6.4%	0.2%	1.9%
ELF Skin Care	25	5	4.93	36.9%	-9.8%	51.8%	9.0%	0.7%	0.2%	6.1%
Naturium Skin Care	26	12	2.08	23.0%	32.9%	-7.4%	9.4%	0.7%	0.1%	6.1%
Total Skin Care	50	17	2.90	29.5%	16.9%	10.7%	18.4%	1.5%	0.3%	6.1%
Total	273	34	8.09	8.7%	3.2%	5.3%	100.0%	3.9%	0.2%	3.9%

Source: Nielsen Total US xAOC, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **ELF Overall Performance Trends**



Source: Nielsen Total US xAOC, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 15: **ELF Performance Trends by Segment**

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

Bernstein is part of a joint venture between Société Générale (SG) and AllianceBernstein, L.P. (AB). Unless specifically noted otherwise, for purposes of these disclosures, references to Bernstein's "affiliates" relate to both SG and AB and their respective affiliates.

VALUATION METHODOLOGY**elf Beauty Inc**

We value elf using EPS of \$3.52 (NTM+1) and a 17x P/E multiple (implying \$60), cross-checked against EV/EBIT on \$300 EBIT (NTM+1) at 16.8x (implying \$57) and a DCF with 14.1% WACC and 3% terminal growth (implying \$54), with valuation sensitivity primarily driven by EPS growth.

Procter & Gamble Co

We value P&G using EPS of \$7.25 (NTM+1) and a 21.6x P/E multiple (implying \$156), cross-checked against EV/EBIT on \$21,621 EBIT (NTM+1) at 19.4x (implying \$170) and a DCF with 8.3% WACC and 2% terminal growth (implying \$108), with valuation sensitivity primarily driven by EPS growth.

Colgate-Palmolive Co

We value Colgate-Palmolive using EPS of \$4.14 (NTM+1) and a 23.1x P/E multiple (implying \$96), cross-checked against EV/EBIT on \$4,750 EBIT (NTM+1) at 18.8x (implying \$102) and a DCF with 7.7% WACC and 2% terminal growth (implying \$85), with valuation sensitivity primarily driven by EPS growth.

RISKS**elf Beauty Inc**

We see the following downside risks to our ELF Price Target:

- Decreased consumer demand driven by economic pressure on consumers (e.g., inflation, unemployment)
- Loss of market share to other companies, including consumers trading-down to Private Label products
- Commodity costs and/or FX fluctuations
- Changes in elf Beauty's stances towards M&A or the prioritization of cash in general

And we see the following upside risks to our ELF Price Target:

- Brand heat and social-media-driven marketing keep customer acquisition costs low, sustaining elevated top-line growth

Procter & Gamble Co

We see the following downside risks to our P&G Price Target:

- Decreased consumer demand driven by economic pressure on consumers (e.g., inflation, unemployment)

- Loss of market share to other companies, including consumers trading-down to Private Label products
- Commodity costs and/or FX fluctuations
- Changes in our covered companies' stances towards M&A or the prioritization of cash in general

And we see the following upside risks to our P&G Price Target:

- Cost savings and productivity programs drop more to the bottom line than expected.

Colgate-Palmolive Co

We see the following downside risks to our CL Price Target:

- Decreased consumer demand driven by economic pressure on consumers (e.g., inflation, unemployment)
- Loss of market share to other companies, including consumers trading-down to Private Label products
- Commodity costs and/or FX fluctuations
- Changes in Colgate's stances towards M&A or the prioritization of cash in general

And we see the following upside risks to our CL Price Target:

- Oral care and pet nutrition volumes remain solid despite macro pressure, proving less cyclical than feared and supporting steady MSD organic growth.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

Bernstein brand

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
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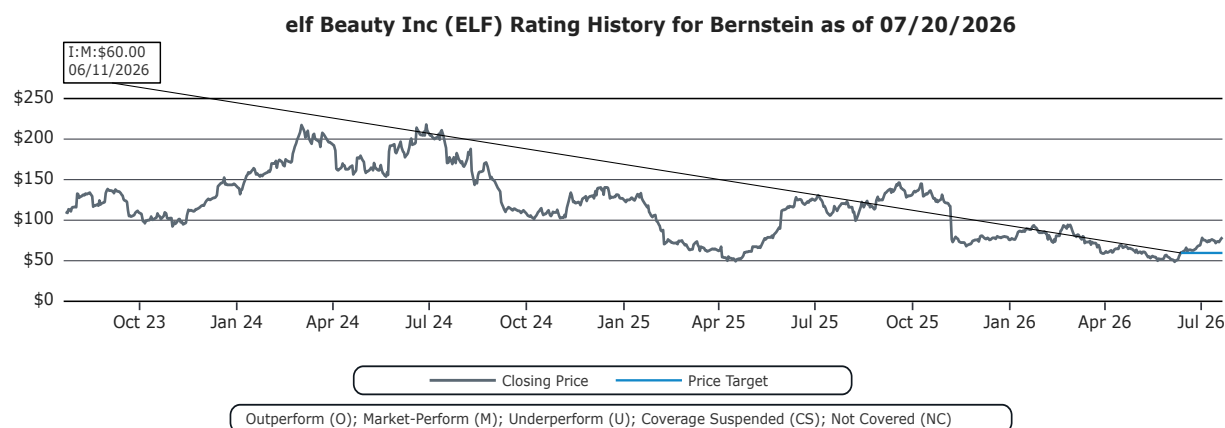
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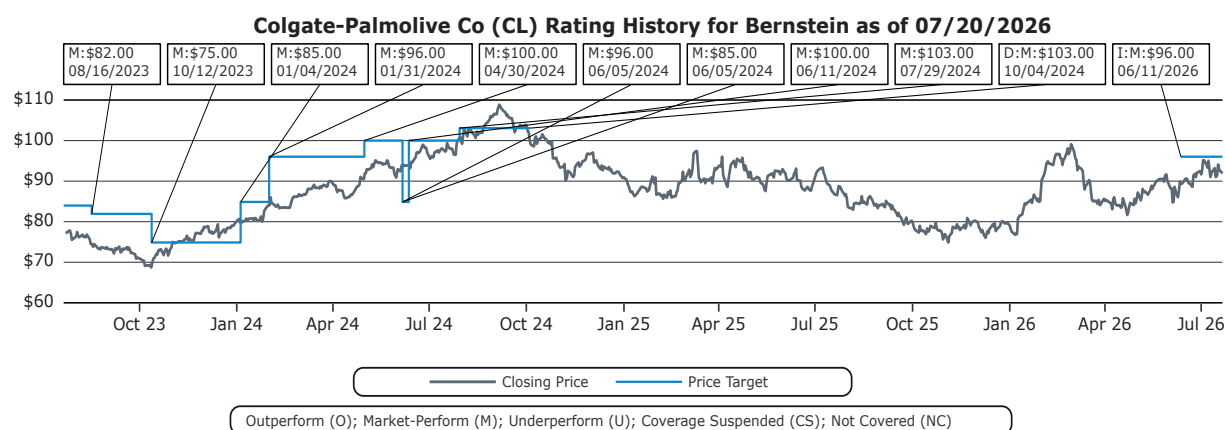
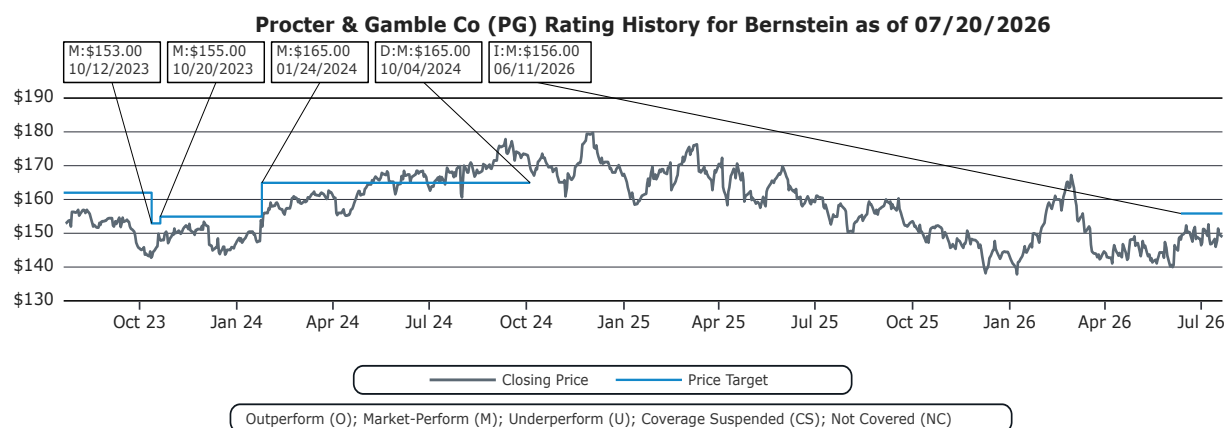
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